

High Renaissance

Italian architecture during the late 15th century and early 16th saw still further refinements in the assimilation and translation of Roman ideas; buildings became less massive, as architects followed Bramante's lead in combining the ideas of Vitruvius, Alberti and Leonardo; meanwhile, the contrasting approaches of Raphael and Michelangelo ensured a diversity of styles prevailed during the High Renaissance.

The central plan arrangements of Roman temples became especially popular, with Francesco di Giorgio (1439–1502), Peruzzi, Raphael and Sangallo expressing these in churches, cathedrals, suburban villas and palaces, such as the Villa Farnesina (1505–10), the Villa Madama (1518–25) and the Palazzo Farnese (begun 1517, opposite), all in Rome. Michelangelo's New Sacristy in the Medici Chapels (1521–4) in Florence, and the Church of Santa Maria degli Angeli e dei Martiri (1563–6) in Rome, demonstrated classical interpretations fused with even more ambitious new ideas.

